

Artsy Short Vowel Words

Orton-Gillingham Concept: Short vowel sounds

Science: Chromatography and capillary action

Materials:

1. Coffee filters
2. Water-based markers and/or overhead transparency markers/pens
3. Plate and water

Directions:

1. Give coffee filter to students and have them fold them in half and then fold it in half again.
2. Dictate short vowel words and students spell the words as they sound using the pens (one or two different colors - black, red, green, etc.). Have them write these words about 2 inches from the edge.
3. Turn the coffee upside down and stand it on the plate. Add a small amount of water (enough to touch all edges of the paper).
4. As the water rises, the colored words will move. Some of the colors will also separate into several colors.

Explanation: Water moves upward into the filter by capillary action. It then dissolves the marker's words. Any ink that is made up of more than one color will be separated into their component colors.